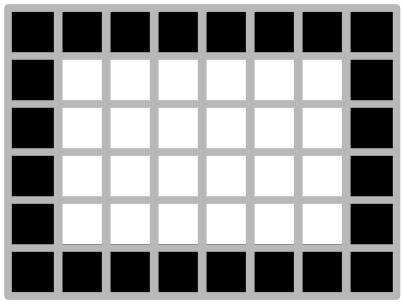
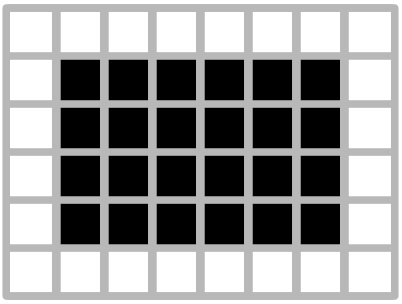
MathsJam Shout

March 2026
Bristol MathsJam

Puzzle
Double Negative





This pixel artwork uses 24 tiles of each colour, with a frame of thickness 1.

This means the frame and picture can be swapped. If you have an infinite number of each colour of tiles, and the frame can be any thickness, are there other ways to do this? How many can you find?

Puzzle
Night Crossing

Four people come to cross a suspension bridge in the night. Because of maintenance, only two people at a time are allowed on it. They all share one torch and, because it's night, the torch has to be used when crossing the bridge.

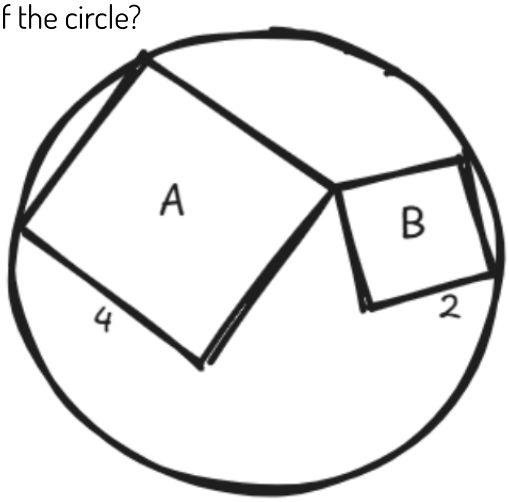
Person A can cross the bridge in 1 minute, B in 2 minutes, C in 5 minutes, and D in 8 minutes. When two people cross the bridge together, they must move at the slower person's pace.

Can they all get across the bridge if the torch lasts only 15 minutes?

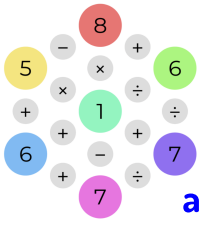


Puzzle
Circles and Squares

Two squares A and B are touching on a corner, and each square is touching the circle with 2 other corners. The side length of A is 4 and the side length of B is 2. What is the area of the circle?



Play
Ophex



Try this daily puzzle game of arithmetic and logical thinking.

andrewt.net/puzzles/ophex

MathsJam Shout is a monthly sheet of ideas for activities to do at a MathsJam night. It's created using suggestions from a different MathsJam each month, and if you'd like to submit suggestions for a month in the future, email **katie@mathsjam.com**

Maths Jam is a monthly opportunity for like-minded self-confessed maths enthusiasts to get together in a pub and share stuff they like. Puzzles, games, problems, or just anything they think is cool or interesting. Monthly Maths Jam nights happen in over 70 locations around the world, on the second-to-last Tuesday of each month. To find your nearest Maths Jam, visit the website at **mathsjam.com.**